

BMM Alignment Discussion

Terry, Scott and I volunteered to work on the BACM alignment with BMM. Over the past 2 weeks we've exchanged ideas and briefly caught up with Jim by email. I've tried to capture this below, include some elaboration and present a draft set of concepts to illustrate some of the key points.

Considerations:

We consider the BMM to be a classification framework that can be applied to the BACM. There are some specific cases that warrant more direct metamodel integration in order to achieve this.

BMM Strategy and Tactics can be considered a category/classification of an Initiatives in BACM. Similarly, Regulation, Business Rule and Business Policy can be considered categories for Policy in BACM. Categories are already available in BACM, so this seems to fit well. For Strategy and Tactics at any rate, we could simply model them as Categories and the Initiatives relate well.

Some concepts from BMM could be used as direct abstractions of BACM types. For example, a BMM Desired Result can be an abstraction of an Objective; Course Of Action for Initiative, and Directive for Policy. We can introduce these to the BACM as abstract parer 

There are some concrete concepts like Objectives are already aligned – use them. We'd argue include a Goal as a concrete type as well, as this is unbounded in time, whereas you could consider an Objective to be more specific. You could also argue that you don't require a Goal if you have a classification for an Objective, or else simply treat it as a goal.

Having a Rationale adds specific "motivation" to an Objective. It seems reasonable to single this out rather than broadly treat items as a BMM MotivationElement. If we include Desired Result, it may be worthwhile moving Rationale up to this level.

Other concepts that don't align well are covered can be grouping them into higher level classification of the types. Influencers and Assessments are two areas. Assessments can be made of the impact of change to the business. BACM has an Affect Role Element and this could be related to this.

Stakeholders can be considered influencers. However, it depends on their role. For instance, a Market Segment could influence Product development; a Stakeholder could set and influence Policy; Policy can influence Courses of Action and other behavior. BACM has an Influences Role Element already, so this has some further alignme 

Terry also suggested (with *my comments*):

- Initiative can be modeled as a Tactic and that a Project is an Initiative.
I've modeled the Initiatives with a category in the below (as I felt they could be of a strategic nature at times, and could even change their category over time), and the BACM already has a way to treat Initiatives as Programs or Projects.
- Influencers and Stakeholders are either synonyms or Influencers are a subclass of Stakeholder. *I tend to favour usage as a role, yet if they are disjoint could work this way.*
- Assessments are a type of Control (under Directives or Governance) and thinks BMM takes a very narrow approach thinking that hat an assessment must be a SWOT Analysis. Most Heatmap values are an assessment.
- Rationale sounds to me like Motivation which is then a completely recursive concept.
- Considering Capabilities, Products and all Resources (People, Tools, Assets etc) as Ends. They represent the state of affairs the business is pursuing.

From Jim:

The current Strategy package was designed as an abstraction of parts of the BMM, specifically Means (Course of Action) and Ends (Objectives). Consequently, it should be quite feasible to align a model created from the BMM metamodel with a model created from the BACM metamodel.

There are parts (Influencers and Assessments) of the BMM that are not covered conceptually by the BACM strategy concepts, The BACM introduces the notion of a Rationale (taken from OMG standards on software assurance and argumentation theory generally). Some part of the concept of Assessments is likely covered generally by the BACM adoption of the OMG Structured Metrics Metamodel. Another part should be covered by Rationale, which at the moment is not decomposed. Influencers should be added, probably aligned with the Stakeholder concept in the BACM. However, Stakeholder is not a person or group, it is a characterization of an interest.

The BACM metamodel for Initiative is not currently in a resolved state. There are some issues around capability-based planning that need to be addressed. I think the BMM is probably too weak to be used for representing initiatives. The important question is: how much of the conceptual framework of a real initiative planning tool needs to be defined in the BACM metamodel in order to allow meaningful rollup of information from ongoing and planned initiatives into the business architecture model (think Balanced Scorecard, for example).

Illustration:

